

» MATCH OF THE
FORTNIGHT

Vinicius to Real's rescue

The forward came up with a brace, including an **83rd minute penalty**, to make it all square ahead of the second leg.

BAYERN MUNICH

2

Sane 53'

Kane 57' (pen)

REAL MADRID

2

Vinicius 24'

Vinicius 83' (pen)

The UEFA Champions League semifinal witnessed a showdown between European royalty as 14-time winner Real Madrid travelled to the Allianz Arena to face six-time champion Bayern Munich.

It was the eighth time the two sides met at the penultimate stage of the competition — the most in tournament history. The two teams had contrasting domestic campaigns before heading into the crucial encounter.

While Real Madrid was within touching distance of the La Liga title, Bayern lost out to Bayer Leverkusen for the Bundesliga, leaving the UCL as its lone opportunity to win a trophy this season.

The home team started brightly with England captain Harry Kane releasing Leroy Sane down the left within the first minute. Sane's low shot across goal was blocked by 'keeper Andriy Lunin's strong left foot.

The Bavarians continued to pile on the pressure in the opening quarter. But the visitor took the lead through Vinicius Junior who was at the end of a perfectly-weighted pass in behind the defence from German midfielder Toni Kroos. After receiving

earfuls from manager Thomas Tuchel for his below-par decision-making, Sane rebounded by firing in the equaliser after the half-time break, cutting in off the right before beating Lunin on his near post with a ferocious shot.

With the scores even, the home team upped the ante, moving the ball forward much quicker. The aggressive approach paid dividends when Jamal Musiala was brought down in the box by Lucas Vazquez. Kane calmly sent the 'keeper the wrong way before slotting in the penalty, giving Bayern the lead in the tie.

With the game trudging into the last 10 minutes, it looked like the home side would carry a slender lead to the Santiago Bernabeu but Los Blancos wrested the advantage back in the 83rd minute.

Vinicius was at the heart of it again, driving through the centre of the box, before laying the ball on to Rodrygo whose nimble footwork helped him draw a foul out of Kim Min-jae. Vinicius put away the resultant penalty kick to make it all square ahead of the second leg.

Karthik Mudaliar & Anish Pathiyil